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FIRST CLIENT · PRE-MEETING PLAYBOOK

The First Client, *Handled*

The first client meeting is coming up. Here is everything to walk in calm, prepared, and looking like this has been done a hundred times.

How to use this pack: the instincts are already right. Notion, the AI notes, getting set up early. But before jumping to tools, this pack gives the thing that makes the tools matter: a way of thinking about the job. Read this first. It will change how the meeting goes. The rest gets built in the working session with Daniel.

First, reframe the job

This one shift is worth more than any tool.

The client did not ask for "some posts." They asked to post on LinkedIn **more regularly**. That word is the whole job. What they actually want is **consistency without effort**, content that keeps showing up without them having to sit down and think about it.

So I am not selling posts. I am building them a **consistency engine**: a simple system that turns their knowledge and stories into a steady stream of content, on repeat, in their voice. Sell that, and I am not a freelancer doing a favour. I am running their content operation. That is a relationship, and relationships pay monthly.

The discovery meeting

The first meeting has one job: leave with a clear content direction. Not posts yet. Direction.

Do not walk in and start talking tools. Walk in and ask questions. The person who asks the best questions runs the room. Here is the question bank, grouped so it flows like a conversation.

The goal (why now)

- Why LinkedIn, and why now? What changed?
- If this works brilliantly, what does it get you in 90 days? Leads, credibility, recruiting, investors?
- How will you know it is working? What are we measuring?

The voice (who is the face)

- Is this your personal profile, the company page, or both?
- What do you want to be known for? If someone described you in one line, what should it say?
- Are there topics or opinions you will not touch?

The audience

- Who exactly are we trying to reach? Paint me a picture of that person.
- What keeps them up at night? What do they wish someone would explain?

The raw material (the gold)

- What have you done or learned that most people in your field have not?
- Tell me a win you are proud of. Tell me a lesson that cost you something.
- What is a common belief in your industry that you think is wrong?

The logistics

- Realistically, how often can you commit to posting? Be honest, we build for what you will sustain.
- How do you want to approve posts before they go live?
- Do you have brand colours, a headshot, any past content I should see?
- Show me three LinkedIn accounts you admire. What do you like about them?

2 The AI notes, done properly

Asking permission is exactly right. Handle it well and it builds trust in the first two minutes.

Ask before anything else in the meeting. Say it warmly and it lands as professional, not awkward:

SAY THIS AT THE TOP

"Before we dive in, I use an AI assistant to take notes so I can stay fully present with you instead of scribbling the whole time. It stays private between us, and I will send you a clean summary straight after. Are you happy for me to do that?"

For the tool itself, pick one and test it before the day so there is no fumbling live. Any of these do the job well:

- **Granola** quietly enhances the notes you type yourself, great for looking present in the room
- **Otter, Fathom, or Fireflies** record and transcribe a call and pull out action points
- **In person?** A phone voice memo plus an AI transcription afterwards works perfectly

The move that looks premium: the recording is not the win. The follow-up is. Within an hour of the meeting, send the client a short, tidy summary: what we covered, what we agreed, what happens next. First-timers forget to follow up. Doing it fast and clean makes me look like the most organised person they have worked with.

3 Notion or "just the AI"? Both. In layers.

Not either or. Think in layers.

Layer 1

Notion, the command centre. This is what the client sees. One tidy dashboard: a content calendar, an idea bank, a draft to approved pipeline, the brand and voice guide, and a simple performance log. It looks organised and gives the client a window into the work.

Layer 2

The AI assistant, the engine. This is the horsepower behind the dashboard. One good interview becomes ten posts. It writes hooks, rewrites in the client's voice, and repurposes one idea five ways. The client never has to touch it. I do.

Layer 3

The AIOS, the automation. This is what Daniel is teaching me. Once the loop has been run by hand a few times, we wire it so it runs itself. This is the unfair advantage. Do not show the client this yet. Master it behind the scenes first.

For this first client, live in Layer 1 and Layer 2. Keep it simple for them. Master Layer 3 in the working sessions. That restraint is the pro skill: give the client calm and consistency, keep the complexity on my side.

4 LinkedIn, the fundamentals

Enough to sound like I know exactly what I am doing. Because after this, I will.

Content pillars beat inspiration

Pick three to five themes the client posts around, forever. Now "what do I post today" is never a blank page, it is "which pillar this time." Example set:

Expertise

Teach one useful thing they know that the audience does not.

Stories

Wins, failures, and lessons. This is what people actually connect with.

Opinions

A clear take on their industry. Respectful, but not on the fence.

Behind the scenes

The real work, the process, the human. Builds trust quietly.

The first two lines are 80 percent of the job

On LinkedIn, people see only the opening line or two before "see more." If that hook does not stop them, nothing else you wrote matters. Spend most of your effort there. Short, curious, or a little bold.

Consistency beats volume

Three strong posts a week, every week, will out-perform seven rushed ones that stop after a fortnight. LinkedIn rewards showing up. Build for a pace the client can actually keep.

The first 20 minutes matter

After a post goes live, the client (or you on their behalf) should reply to every comment and go comment on a few other people's posts. Early engagement tells LinkedIn the post is worth showing to more people.

Write like they talk

One idea per post. Short lines. Plain words. Read it out loud, if it does not sound like the client speaking, rewrite it. The AI drafts fast, your job is to make it sound human.

5 The Thursday working session

The client prep is above. This part is about the business itself.

No business name or branding yet, which is good: it means it gets built right from the start. The Thursday session with Daniel maps out:

- **Positioning and name** who the business is for, what it does, and a name and look that fits it, built through the AIOS
- **A content operating system** the AIOS approach, so several clients can run at once without drowning
- **Offer and pricing** how to package this so it is a monthly relationship, not one-off jobs
- **The exchange** how the content work and the AI teaching trade fairly, and what each side delivers

Come with the raw thoughts. They get shaped into something real on the day.

Before the session, a short list

Do what you can. Whatever is not done gets done together.

- ☐ Pick the AI note-taker and test it once, so it is second nature by the client meeting
- ☐ Look up the client: their LinkedIn, their website, the three competitors you can find
- ☐ Draft the discovery questions above into your own words
- ☐ Jot down any early thoughts on what to call the business and who it is for
- ☐ Write down the one outcome wanted from the first client meeting (hint: a clear content direction and an agreed posting rhythm)

More ready than *you think*

The nerves before a first client are just proof you care about doing it well. You have the eye, you have been creating for years. What is being added now is the system underneath it, so the talent scales. This is going to be something that lasts.

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